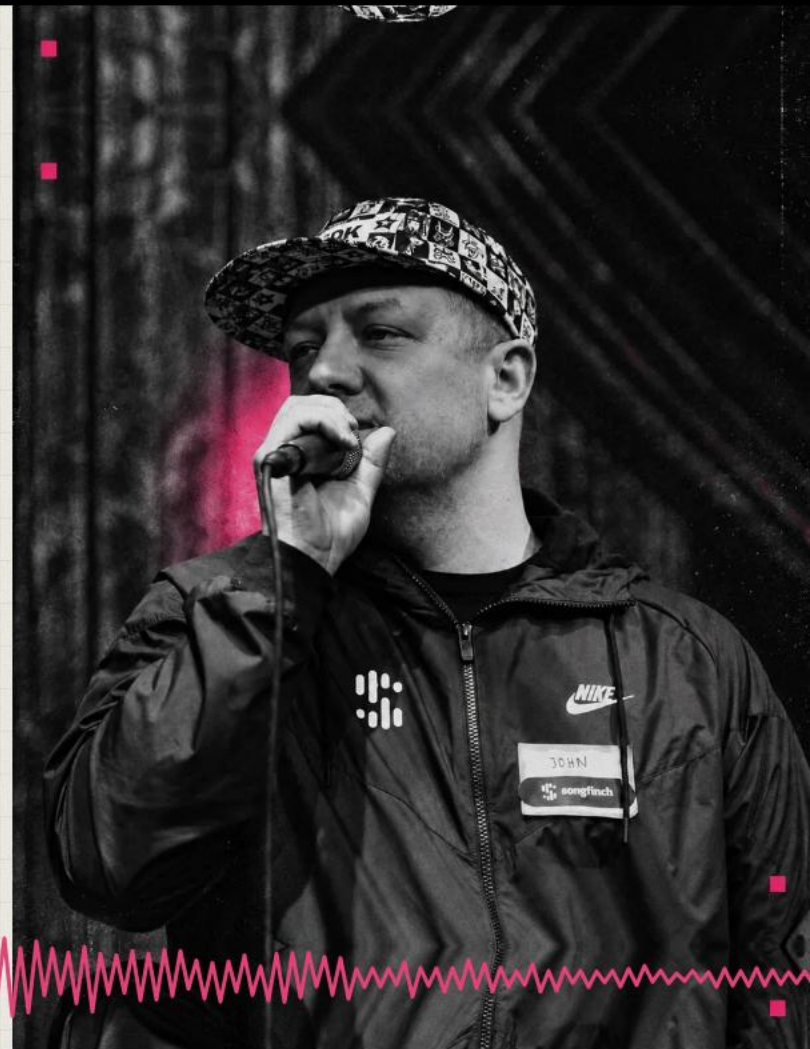


■ A TALK ON SYNC LICENSING · WHY IT MATTERS, HOW TO GET IN

EVERY SCENE NEEDS A SONG. WHY NOT YOURS?

How music gets into film, TV, ads and
games, and how yours gets there too.

JOHN WILLIAMSON · CO-FOUNDER, MUSIC DEALERS · SONGFINCH · UPPERHAND



■ 01 · WHO IS TALKING

I DROPPED OUT. THEN I BUILT A COMPANY AROUND SYNC.

THE SHORT VERSION

Three decades starting and running companies. Music, food, consumer brands, software, sports. Every job in every one of them, CEO to mopping the floor.

CHICAGO, 2008

Co-founded Music Dealers to answer one question: why can't an unsigned artist get a song into a global ad?

WHY I AM HERE

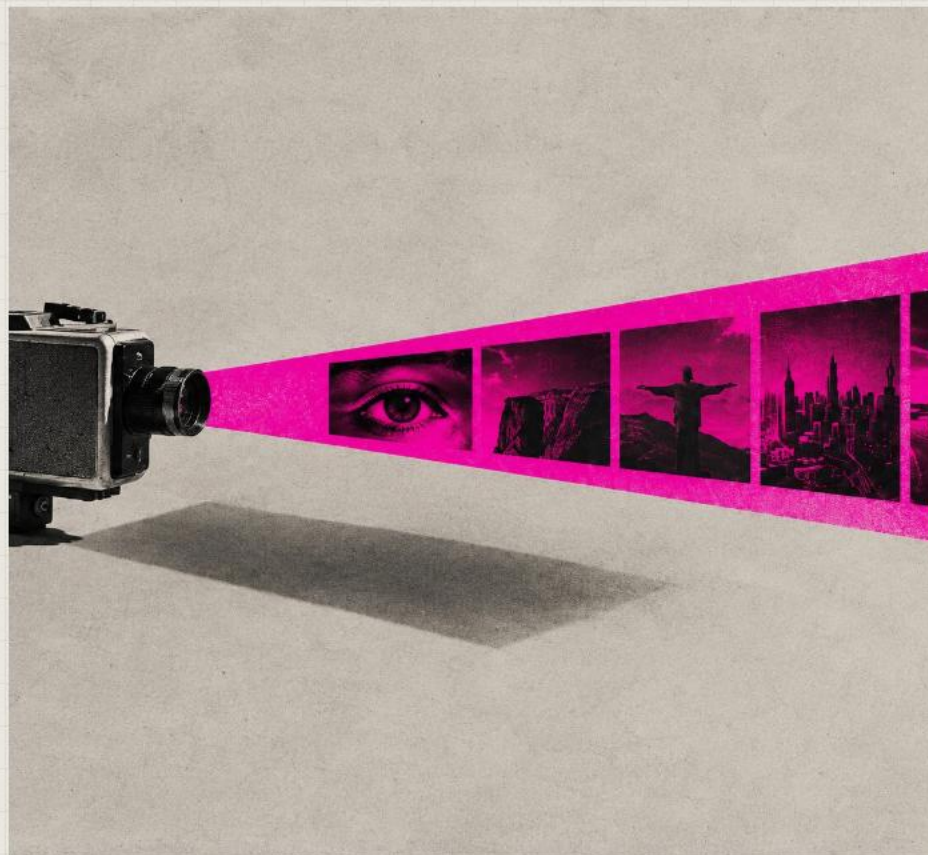
Everything I know about this came from doing it. I would rather hand you that than a theory.

■ 02 · THE DEFINITION

SYNC IS MUSIC **MARRIED** TO PICTURE.

Any time a song is synchronized to
moving images, somebody licensed it.
Film. Series. Ads. Trailers. Games.
Promos. A brand's social post.

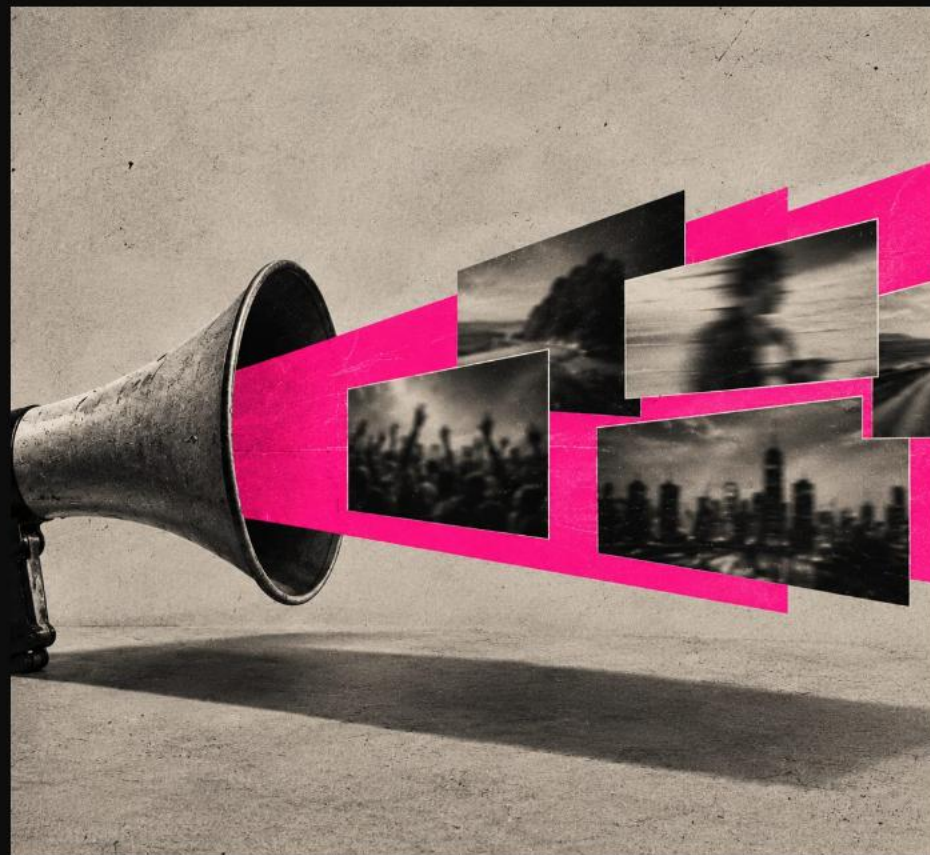
if it moves and it has music, that is a job



■ 03 · WHY IT MATTERS

NOBODY REMEMBERS THE SCENE WITHOUT THE **SONG.**

- 01 **For the picture:** a song tells an audience how to feel in three seconds. Brands and shows pay for that.
- 02 **For you:** a fee up front, royalties when it airs, and strangers looking you up by name.
- 03 **For a career:** one placement is a credit. Credits get the next call returned.



■ 04 · THE ONE THING TO UNDERSTAND

EVERY SONG IS TWO RIGHTS. SYNC NEEDS **BOTH**.

RIGHT ONE

THE MASTER

The recording itself. Whoever paid for and owns that specific recording. Licensed with a master use license.

RIGHT TWO

THE COMPOSITION

The song underneath: melody and lyrics. Owned by the writers and their publishers. Licensed with a sync license.

1 The fee. Paid up front, split between the two sides.

2 The royalties. Paid by your PRO every time it airs.

■ 05 • WHAT IT WAS

IT USED TO BE A **LOCKED** DOOR.

- 01 Supervisors called the major labels, the big publishers, and a handful of agents they already knew.
- 02 Clearing one song meant chasing every owner of both rights. It could take weeks.
- 03 If you were unsigned, you were not in the room. Nobody was being cruel. There was just no door.



■ 06 · MUSIC DEALERS · CHICAGO · 2008

SO WE **OPENED** IT.

IDEA ONE

THE OPEN BRIEF

A brand posts what it needs: the feeling, the references, the budget. Any independent artist can answer it.

IDEA TWO

PRE-CLEARED, ONE STOP

Artists confirmed they controlled both rights. A brand could say yes and use the song right away.

IDEA THREE

YOU KEEP YOUR SONG

Non-exclusive. The artist kept every copyright and could license the same song anywhere else.

■ COCA-COLA'S GLOBAL MUSIC PARTNER, 2011

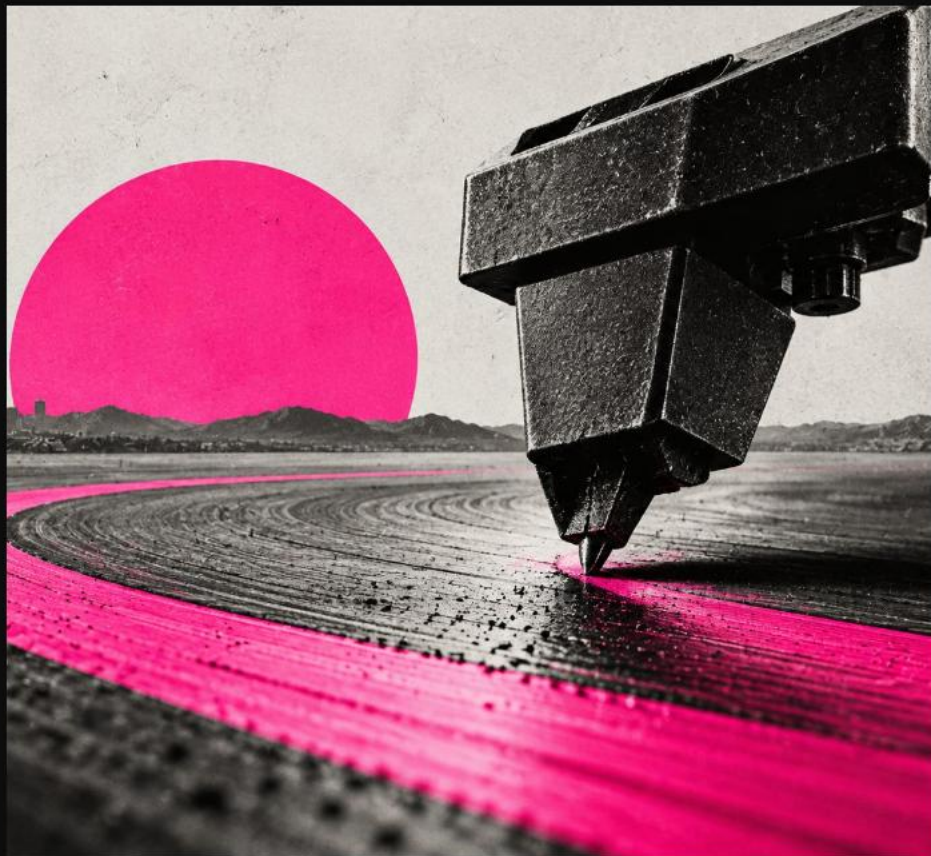
■ \$15M+ IN LICENSING FEES

■ INC. 5000

■ 07 · WHAT IT IS NOW · 2026

ONE-STOP WON.

- 01 Pre-cleared is the default. Libraries and marketplaces built on it are everywhere.
- 02 There are more screens than ever: series, games, podcasts, creators, every brand's feed. All of it needs cleared music, fast.
- 03 The famous song still costs a fortune. The background is nearly free. Independent artists live in the middle, and the middle is big.



■ 08 · WHERE IT IS GOING

MACHINES TAKE THE BACKGROUND. PEOPLE TAKE THE SCENE.

Generated music will fill the space nobody listens to. That makes a real song, by a real person with a story and clean paperwork, worth more when the moment matters. Brands increasingly want the artist, not just the track.



■ 09 · HOW TO GET PLACED, PART ONE

THE SONG THAT CLEARS **FASTEST** WINS.

these two pick the easy yes

- ☐ Control 100% of the master and the composition, or know exactly who does.
- ☐ Splits agreed in writing before the song comes out. Every co-writer, every producer.
- ☐ Registered with a PRO: ASCAP, BMI or SESAC. That is how royalties find you.
- ☐ An instrumental, a clean version and stems, bounced and ready.
- ☐ Metadata in the file: your contact, writers, splits, mood, tempo.
- ☐ No uncleared samples. One will kill the deal.

■ 10 · HOW TO GET PLACED, PART TWO

THREE DOORS IN. PITCH THE **SCENE**, NOT THE SONG.

DOOR ONE

LIBRARIES AND MARKETPLACES

Volume and reach. Usually non-exclusive.
Read the terms, then upload your cleanest
work.

DOOR TWO

SYNC AGENTS AND PUBLISHERS

They pitch for you and take a share. Worth it
when they have relationships you do not.

DOOR THREE

SUPERVISORS AND BRANDS, DIRECT

Do the research. One short email, one link, no
attachments. Say where the song fits.

■ 11 · HOMEWORK

THIS WEEK: REGISTER **ONE** SONG. BOUNCE **ONE** INSTRUMENTAL.

Then write down who owns what. You will be ahead of most people pitching music today.

JOHN WILLIAMSON · HELLO@GETUPPERHAND.IO · GETUPPERHAND.IO



THESE SLIDES